

Goals of Incident Response

1. Verify that an incident occurred.
2. Maintain or Restore Business Continuity.
3. Reduce the incident impact.
4. Determine how the attack was done (i.e. the incident happened).
5. Prevent future attacks or incidents.
6. Improve security and incident response.
7. Prosecute illegal activity.
8. Keep management informed of the situation and response.



Incident Response Plan

- An Incident Response Plan (IRP) is needed because attacks frequently compromise data within organizations.
- Organizations should have a formal, focused, and coordinated approach to responding to incidents, including an incident response plan that provides the roadmap for implementing the incident response capability.
- Each organization needs a plan that meets its unique requirements, which relates to the organization's mission, size, structure, and functions.
- The plan should lay out the necessary resources and management support.

Elements of Incident Response Plan

- Mission
- Strategies and goals
- Senior management approval
- Organizational approach to incident response
- How the incident response team will communicate with the rest of the organization and with other organizations
- Metrics for measuring the incident response capability and its effectiveness
- Roadmap for maturing the incident response capability
- How the program fits into the overall organization.

Requirements of Incident Response Plan

- A Framework
- Skilled Resource
- Latest Tools
- Dedicated Team
- Proper Documentation
- Collaboration, Etc.

Three Functions

- **Incident Reporting :**
 - Such functions enables a CERT to serve as a central point of contact for reporting problems
 - Allows all incidents reports and activity to be collected in one location
 - Here, Information can be reviewed and correlated across the organization
 - Information can then be used to determine patterns of intruders or activity
- **Incident Analysis**
- **Incident Response**

Three Functions

- **Incident Reporting**
- **Incident Analysis:**
 - Recommendation of corresponding preventative strategies can be given
 - In-depth look at an incident report of the activity to determine the scope, priority and threat of the incident
 - Researching possible response and mitigation strategies.
- **Incident Response**

Three Functions

- Incident Reporting
- Incident Analysis
- Incident Response:
 - It can take many forms
 - A CERT may send out recommendations for recovery, containment and prevention of systems
 - Network administrators at sites then performs the response steps themselves
 - CERT may also perform these steps themselves but only, when network administrators are unable to mitigate the problem
 - Share information and lessons learned with other team members